sole's success. Magnavox re-released their Odyssey system with simplified hardware and new features, and would later release updated versions.

In 1975, a Japanese console called TV Tennis Electrotennis was released in North America, and was considered a home version of Pong. A defining and unique feature of the of the Electrotennis was its wireless capabilities, that worked using a UHF antenna. In addition, a pretty ground-breaking feature that hadn't been recognised at that time was the ability to play in single player mode, which was the first time artificial intelligence was ever added to a video game.

The release of Home Pong heralded the end of the first generation of video game consoles. As something evident from the consoles of this generation, a common characteristic was the lack of removable game cards, that would allow multiple games to be played. Instead, games existed on memory in the machine, and the card would be inserted only to activate a game already on the console. This was because of the usage of discrete transistor based logic in the consoles, in the absence of microprocessor logic, ROM cartridges and sprite-based graphics, which were a huge liability for game-makers.

The lack of uniformity caused a fair number of consoles to be spawned, as each console supported only limited games, and each company would attempt to promote its own version of a game as the accepted standard in the market. In addition, there was a noticeable lack of complicated or even multi-coloured graphics. Most were black and white, and a few could use three or more colors; all detailing was very basic lines, dots and blocks. Another minor point was the absence of audio, which was introduced in later generations.

Second Generation

In a broad overview of the second generation, the Atari 2600 was the dominant console for much of this time period, with other consoles such as the Intellivision, the Odyssey², and ColecoVision also enjoying market share.

The second generation of computer and video games began in 1976 with the release of the Fairchild Channel F, produced by Fairchild Semiconductors, across North America. However, the Channel F has the distinction of being the console that introduced the usage of a programmable ROM cartridge and a microprocessor. Though the graphics were pretty similar to the first generation consoles, with the Channel F using only one plane of colours that had only three colours to choose from, one intriguing part about the console was the existence of an AI that allowed for human vs